

Polar regions

Polar regions are often dark, blasted by freezing winds, and they receive little rain. Only the toughest can survive.

Polar bears have thick blubber under their skin to help keep the cold out.

Polar bear



Although their fur is white, polar bears have black skin.

Polar giants

Large animals lose heat more slowly than small ones, so many Arctic animals are big. A male polar bear can be 2.5 m (8 ft) long and weigh 800 kg (0.8 ton).



Let's stay warm

Penguins huddle together to stay warm. The adults and chicks on the outside of the huddle aren't so well protected from the cold, so they take turns standing in the middle.

To survive blizzards, musk oxen simply sit down and wait, using as little energy as possible.



Musk oxen may look like cattle, but they are actually goats!

A walking coat

The musk ox looks like a small, shaggy-haired buffalo. Its coat, said to be eight times warmer than sheep's wool, is made of coarse hairs as long as your arm.